

AI Disclosure Framework

A Practical Framework for Transparent and Responsible Disclosure of AI Assistance in Academic Work

Version 1.0

Author

Dr. Jabreel Asghar, FHEA

Higher Colleges of Technology, United Arab Emirates

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This framework is provided to support scholarly discussion, institutional implementation, and professional practice. It does not constitute institutional policy or regulatory guidance unless formally adopted by the relevant institution.

About this Framework

The AI Disclosure Framework provides practical guidance for transparent and proportionate disclosure of artificial intelligence within academic work. Rather than treating disclosure as evidence of misconduct or as automatic justification for AI use, the framework positions transparency as a mechanism that enables informed academic

judgement while preserving intellectual responsibility. Building upon the principle of Transparency and Disclosure introduced in *From Assistance to Authorship*, this framework translates conceptual principles into practical guidance for students, educators, programme leaders, and higher education institutions. It proposes that disclosure should be proportionate to the educational significance of AI assistance and should support, rather than replace, professional academic judgement.

Executive Summary

Generative artificial intelligence has become an increasingly common component of academic work. Students and researchers now use AI to improve writing, organise ideas, summarise information, generate code, explain concepts, and support many other aspects of learning and scholarship. In response, universities have introduced disclosure requirements intended to promote transparency and preserve trust in academic assessment.

Despite these developments, institutional guidance often remains inconsistent. Some policies require disclosure of every interaction with AI, while others provide only broad statements that offer little practical guidance. Students are therefore frequently uncertain about what should be disclosed, how much detail is expected, and whether disclosure itself may disadvantage them academically.

The AI Disclosure Framework addresses this problem by providing a structured approach to disclosure based on the educational significance of AI's contribution rather than the mere presence of AI within the learning process.

The framework complements *From Assistance to Authorship* by operationalising the principle of **Transparency and Disclosure**. It also aligns with the **AI-Integrated Assessment Integrity Lifecycle**, supporting disclosure at the appropriate stages of assessment while preserving intellectual responsibility and meaningful academic judgement.

The framework does not treat disclosure as evidence of misconduct or as automatic justification for AI use. Instead, it positions disclosure as an essential mechanism for enabling informed evaluation of AI-assisted academic work.

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1. Introduction

Transparency has long been recognised as a fundamental principle of academic integrity. Researchers acknowledge funding sources, disclose conflicts of interest, identify collaborators, and describe methodological decisions to enable informed evaluation of their work. These practices do not diminish scholarly credibility; rather, they strengthen trust by making important aspects of the research process visible.

AI-assisted academic work should be approached in a similar manner.

Disclosure is not intended to discourage responsible AI use, nor should it be viewed as a punitive administrative requirement. Its primary purpose is to provide educators, supervisors, reviewers, and examiners with sufficient information to understand how AI contributed to the development of academic work.

The challenge, however, lies in determining what information should reasonably be disclosed.

If every interaction with AI requires detailed reporting, disclosure becomes burdensome and educationally unhelpful. Conversely, if significant AI contributions remain undisclosed, evaluators may be unable to determine whether the submitted work continues to represent the author's own intellectual achievement.

This model proposes a balanced alternative based upon proportionality.

The extent of disclosure should be proportionate to the educational significance of AI's contribution and sufficient to support informed academic evaluation.

2. Why Disclosure Matters

Disclosure serves several complementary purposes within higher education.

First, it supports **transparency**. Educators cannot evaluate AI-assisted work fairly if important aspects of the writing or learning process remain concealed.

Second, it protects **academic accountability**. Students remain responsible for submitted work even when AI has assisted certain aspects of its development.

Third, it promotes **institutional trust**. Open acknowledgement of AI use demonstrates honesty and allows academic judgement to be exercised with appropriate contextual information.

Finally, disclosure supports **responsible AI literacy**. By encouraging students to reflect upon how AI contributed to their work, disclosure becomes part of the learning process rather than merely an administrative requirement.

Importantly, disclosure should not be interpreted as a mechanism for identifying misconduct. Appropriate AI use, when openly acknowledged and educationally justified, may be entirely consistent with institutional expectations.

The purpose of disclosure is therefore to make AI use visible—not to determine automatically whether that use is acceptable.

3. The Five Principles of Good Disclosure

Effective disclosure should satisfy five core principles.

3.1 Honesty

Disclosure should accurately represent the role AI played during the development of the work.

Students should neither exaggerate nor minimise AI assistance.

3.2 Proportionality

The level of detail should reflect the significance of AI's contribution.

Minor language editing generally requires less detailed disclosure than AI-supported analytical interpretation or substantial drafting.

3.3 Specificity

Disclosure should identify what AI was used for rather than simply naming the software.

For example:

"ChatGPT was used to improve grammar and sentence clarity."

is considerably more informative than:

"ChatGPT was used."

3.4 Educational Relevance

Disclosure should focus upon AI activities that influenced learning, reasoning, analysis, interpretation, or scholarly communication.

Routine technical interactions that have little educational significance need not always receive identical levels of reporting.

3.5 Evaluability

Disclosure should provide sufficient information for educators to understand the nature of AI assistance and evaluate the work appropriately.

The purpose is not exhaustive documentation but meaningful transparency.

4. AI Disclosure Continuum

Not every AI interaction requires the same level of disclosure.

The framework therefore proposes a **AI Disclosure Continuum**, in which expectations increase as AI contributes more directly to the intellectual substance of academic work.

Level of AI Contribution	Typical Examples	Disclosure Expectation
Minimal	Spell checking, grammar correction, formatting	Usually none or a brief acknowledgement, subject to institutional policy
Limited	Language refinement, improving clarity, translation	Brief disclosure where required
Moderate	Brainstorming, outlining, generating discussion questions	Short explanation of AI's role
Substantial	Drafting sections, summarising literature, restructuring arguments	Detailed disclosure describing the extent of AI assistance

Level of AI Contribution	Typical Examples	Disclosure Expectation
Extensive	Interpretation of findings, generating analytical arguments, writing conclusions	Full disclosure and careful educational evaluation of whether authorship and learning outcomes have been preserved

The continuum recognises that disclosure expectations should reflect the educational significance of AI assistance rather than simply the amount of AI-generated text.

5. What Should Be Disclosed?

The objective of disclosure is not to document every interaction with artificial intelligence. Rather, it is to provide sufficient information for educators to understand whether AI influenced the intellectual development of the submitted work.

The present guidance therefore recommends that disclosure focus on **educationally significant AI contributions**.

Students should describe:

- **what AI was used for;**
- **which parts of the assessment were affected;**
- **how AI outputs were used;**
- **which intellectual decisions remained their own.**

Naming the AI tool alone provides little educational value. More informative disclosures explain the nature of AI's contribution to the work.

For example:

AI was used to improve grammar and sentence fluency after the analysis had been completed independently.

is considerably more informative than:

ChatGPT was used.

Similarly,

AI suggested several possible themes during initial brainstorming; however, all final themes, interpretations, and conclusions were developed independently.

provides evaluators with meaningful contextual information that supports informed judgement.

6. What Normally Does Not Require Detailed Disclosure

Although institutional policies differ, routine technical assistance that does not materially influence intellectual work will not usually require extensive disclosure.

Examples include:

- correcting spelling and punctuation;
- minor grammar correction;
- formatting references;
- adjusting document layout;
- accessibility support;
- converting file formats;
- basic transcription where no analytical interpretation occurs.

Where institutional policy requires disclosure of all AI use, these activities may still be acknowledged briefly.

The principle remains proportionality.

Administrative reporting should not become more demanding than the educational significance of the AI contribution itself.

7. AI Uses That Normally Require Disclosure

The following activities directly influence academic work and should normally be disclosed.

Idea Development

- brainstorming research questions;
- generating possible arguments;

- suggesting conceptual frameworks;
 - developing outlines.
-

Information Organisation

- restructuring drafts;
 - organising literature;
 - proposing section headings;
 - identifying possible themes.
-

Writing Support

- drafting paragraphs;
 - rewriting sections;
 - summarising literature;
 - simplifying complex explanations.
-

Analytical Assistance

- interpreting findings;
- proposing explanations;
- comparing theories;
- suggesting conclusions;
- evaluating evidence.

These activities increasingly influence scholarly judgement and therefore require greater transparency.

8. Model Disclosure Statements

The following examples illustrate disclosure statements that institutions may adapt according to local policy.

Example 1 — Language Support

Artificial intelligence was used to improve grammar, sentence fluency, and overall readability after the academic content had been completed independently. All ideas, arguments, analysis, and conclusions remain my own.

Example 2 — Brainstorming

AI was used during the planning stage to generate possible research questions and organise initial ideas. All subsequent analysis, interpretation, and writing were completed independently by the author.

Example 3 — Literature Review

AI assisted with organising notes and producing preliminary summaries of selected sources. Each source was subsequently reviewed directly, and all interpretations, synthesis, and critical evaluation were completed independently.

Example 4 — Data Analysis

AI was used to explain statistical terminology and suggest alternative approaches to presenting findings. Interpretation of results, methodological decisions, and conclusions were developed independently by the author.

Example 5 — Dissertation

AI contributed to language refinement, structural editing, and preliminary brainstorming during drafting. It did not generate the research questions, methodology, data analysis, interpretation, or conclusions. All substantive intellectual decisions remain the responsibility of the author.

9. Examples of Disclosure Quality

Weak Disclosure

AI was used.

Problems:

- too vague;
 - provides no educational context;
 - does not identify AI's role.
-

Adequate Disclosure

AI was used to improve grammar and sentence clarity after the report had been drafted.

Strengths:

- identifies purpose;
 - indicates timing;
 - explains AI's contribution.
-

Strong Disclosure

AI supported early brainstorming and improved language clarity during revision. All literature selection, critical evaluation, interpretation, methodological decisions, and conclusions were completed independently. AI-generated suggestions were reviewed critically and incorporated only where consistent with the author's own academic judgement.

Strengths:

- specific;
 - proportionate;
 - educationally meaningful;
 - supports informed evaluation.
-

10. Common Mistakes

Students frequently misunderstand disclosure expectations.

Common errors include:

Listing the AI Tool Only

ChatGPT

This identifies software but not educational contribution.

Over-Disclosure

Several pages describing every prompt.

This creates unnecessary administrative burden while providing little additional educational value.

Under-Disclosure

Failing to mention AI-assisted drafting or analytical support.

This prevents informed academic evaluation.

Confusing Editing with Authorship

Students sometimes believe that extensive editing automatically makes AI-generated content their own.

Editing alone does not necessarily restore intellectual ownership.

The important question remains:

Who exercised scholarly judgement?

11. Guidance for Educators

Disclosure statements should support academic evaluation rather than replace it.

Educators should avoid treating disclosure as either:

- evidence of misconduct; or
- automatic evidence of acceptable practice.

Instead, disclosure should prompt appropriate professional judgement.

Questions include:

- Was AI used appropriately?
- Was intellectual responsibility preserved?
- Does the disclosure appear proportionate?
- Is further clarification required?

Where uncertainty remains, educational discussion should normally precede disciplinary investigation.

12. Institutional Implementation

Institutions adopting this approach should ensure that disclosure requirements are:

- clearly communicated;
- consistent across programmes;
- proportionate to assessment purpose;
- supported through examples;
- aligned with assessment design.

Students should never be expected to infer disclosure expectations independently.

Likewise, staff should receive guidance regarding how disclosure statements should inform marking and moderation.

Consistency strengthens fairness.

Framework Summary

The AI Disclosure Framework positions disclosure as an educational practice that supports transparency, accountability, and informed academic judgement.

It rejects both extremes:

- requiring exhaustive reporting of insignificant AI interactions; and
- permitting substantial AI contributions to remain undisclosed.

Instead, it proposes proportional disclosure based upon the educational significance of AI's contribution to academic work.

Disclosure therefore becomes neither an administrative burden nor a disciplinary mechanism.

It becomes a means of preserving trust in AI-assisted learning.

13. Institutional AI Disclosure Template

The following template is intended for adaptation by higher education institutions. It may be incorporated into assignment submission systems, dissertations, research projects, or assessment coversheets.

AI Disclosure Statement

AI Tool(s) Used

Purpose of AI Use

(Select all that apply.)

- ☐ Grammar and language refinement
- ☐ Spelling and proofreading
- ☐ Translation
- ☐ Brainstorming
- ☐ Outline development
- ☐ Literature organisation
- ☐ Draft revision
- ☐ Summarisation
- ☐ Coding assistance
- ☐ Data analysis support
- ☐ Other

Brief Description

Describe how AI contributed to your work.

Author Declaration

I confirm that:

- ☐ I remain fully responsible for the intellectual content of this work.
- ☐ AI assistance has been disclosed accurately.
- ☐ All analysis, interpretation, arguments, and conclusions presented as my own represent my own academic judgement unless explicitly acknowledged.

Student Signature

Date

14. Student AI Disclosure Template

The institutional form above may be more detailed than many assessments require.

For routine coursework, the following shorter template is usually sufficient.

Artificial intelligence was used to support the preparation of this assessment by assisting with:

- ☐ language refinement
- ☐ brainstorming
- ☐ organisation
- ☐ other (specify)

AI did not replace my independent analysis, interpretation, or academic judgement. I remain fully responsible for the submitted work.

15. Lecturer Review Checklist

Disclosure should support professional judgement rather than replace it.

When reviewing AI disclosure statements, educators may consider the following questions.

Transparency

- ☐ Is the disclosure sufficiently clear?
 - ☐ Does it identify AI's actual role?
 - ☐ Is it proportionate?
-

Intellectual Responsibility

- ☐ Does the student clearly retain ownership?
 - ☐ Does the disclosure distinguish between AI assistance and human judgement?
 - ☐ Are major intellectual decisions attributable to the student?
-

Functional Limitation

- ☐ Did AI remain within supportive functions?
 - ☐ Did AI generate substantive disciplinary reasoning?
 - ☐ Does the assessment still demonstrate the intended learning outcomes?
-

Educational Follow-up

- ☐ Is no further action required?
- ☐ Is clarification advisable?
- ☐ Would an educational conversation be helpful?
- ☐ Is formal academic integrity review justified?

Most disclosures should conclude with the first option.

Formal investigation should remain exceptional rather than routine.

☐ Would feedback on responsible AI use support future learning?

16. Student Decision Guide

Should I Disclose My AI Use?

This guide is intended to support student decision-making before submission.

Question 1

Did AI influence any part of your academic work?

No

→ No disclosure normally required unless institutional policy requires declaration of all AI use.

Yes

↓

Question 2

Did AI contribute only to grammar, spelling, formatting, or similar technical improvements?

Yes

→ Brief disclosure may be sufficient (subject to institutional policy).

No

↓

Question 3

Did AI contribute ideas, organisation, summaries, drafting, interpretation, or analytical suggestions?

Yes

↓

Disclosure should explain:

- what AI contributed;

- how AI outputs were used;
- which intellectual decisions remained your own.

↓

Question 4

Could an educator understand your AI contribution after reading the disclosure?

Yes

The disclosure is probably adequate.

No

Provide additional explanation.

17. Frequently Asked Questions

I only used AI to improve grammar.

Should I disclose it?

Usually a brief statement is sufficient where disclosure is expected. Some institutions may not require disclosure for routine proofreading assistance.

AI suggested several ideas, but I rejected most of them.

Should I disclose this?

Normally yes.

Disclosure concerns meaningful AI interaction rather than only AI content appearing in the final submission.

AI wrote several paragraphs that I completely rewrote.

Do I still disclose this?

If AI substantially contributed to the intellectual development of those sections, disclosure is advisable.

My supervisor encouraged me to use AI.

Do I still disclose it?

Yes.

Educational approval does not replace transparency.

Will disclosure reduce my marks?

Responsible disclosure should not normally affect grading.

Educators assess learning outcomes, not simply the presence of AI.

Does disclosure prove my work is legitimate?

No.

Disclosure enables informed academic judgement.

It does not replace professional evaluation.

18. Relationship with the Companion Framework Suite

This disclosure framework operationalises the principle of **Transparency and Disclosure** established in *From Assistance to Authorship*.

It also supports implementation of the **AI-Integrated Assessment Integrity Lifecycle**, particularly during:

- Student Preparation
- AI Guidance
- Assessment Completion
- Submission
- Verification

The remaining companion resources address complementary aspects of responsible AI governance.

Framework	Contribution
From Assistance to Authorship	Conceptual foundation
AI-Integrated Assessment Integrity Lifecycle	Implementation across assessment
Oral Verification Toolkit	Verification of intellectual ownership
Assessment Authenticity Checklist	Authentic assessment design
AI Risk-Level Matrix	Evaluation of educational significance
Institutional AI Governance Guide	Institution-wide implementation

Together they provide an integrated institutional approach.

19. Limitations

This model is intended to guide educational practice rather than prescribe universal disclosure rules.

Institutional policies, disciplinary conventions, publisher requirements, and assessment purposes will inevitably differ.

Accordingly, disclosure expectations should always be interpreted within local academic contexts while preserving the broader principles of honesty, proportionality, specificity, educational relevance, and evaluability.

The framework has not yet undergone formal empirical validation as a disclosure instrument and should therefore be regarded as a conceptual and practice-informed framework.

20. Conclusion

Disclosure has become one of the defining features of AI governance within higher education.

Yet transparency should not be confused with either permission or misconduct.

The educational value of disclosure lies in enabling informed academic judgement while preserving trust between students, educators, institutions, and society.

The AI Disclosure Framework therefore proposes a balanced approach.

It rejects exhaustive reporting of insignificant AI interactions while also rejecting the concealment of substantial AI contributions.

Instead, it promotes disclosure that is honest, proportionate, specific, educationally meaningful, and sufficient to support fair evaluation.

As AI continues to become integrated into learning and scholarship, responsible disclosure will remain an essential component of trustworthy academic practice.

Framework Status

Framework type: Operational disclosure framework

Development status: Conceptual and practice-informed

Empirical status: This disclosure framework has not yet undergone formal empirical validation as a disclosure instrument and should be regarded as conceptual and practice-informed.

Primary users:

- Students
- Lecturers
- Supervisors
- Programme leaders
- Academic integrity staff
- Quality assurance teams
- Higher education institutions

Companion frameworks:

- From Assistance to Authorship
- AI-Integrated Assessment Integrity Lifecycle
- Oral Verification Toolkit
- Assessment Authenticity Checklist

- AI Risk-Level Matrix
- Institutional AI Governance Guide for Assessment Integrity

21. Version History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	July 2026	Initial public release

